performance and mental-conditioning coach; Ramji Srinivasan, our fitness trainer; Nitin Patel, our physio; Ramesh Mane and Amit Shah, our masseurs; and Dhananjay, our computer analyst – had all played important roles in our rise to the top. For me, Test cricket is the format that matters the most and this was undoubtedly a high point in my career. The fact that it coincided with my twentieth anniversary in international cricket had made it even more special.

England in India 2008

1st Test. Chennai. 11–15 December 2008

England 316 (AJ Strauss 123, MJ Prior 53*, AN Cook 52; H Singh 3–96, A Mishra 3–99) and 311–9 dec (AJ Strauss 108, PD Collingwood 108; Z Khan 3–40, I Sharma 3–57)

India 241 (MS Dhoni 53, H Singh 40, **SR Tendulkar 37**; A Flintoff 3–49, MS Panesar 3–65) and 387–4 (**SR Tendulkar 103***, Y Singh 85, V Sehwag 83, G Gambhir 66)

India won by 6 wickets

2nd Test. Mohali. 19–23 December 2008

India 453 (G Gambhir 179, R Dravid 136, **SR Tendulkar 11**; A Flintoff 3–54, GP Swann 3–122) and 251–7 dec (G Gambhir 97, Y Singh 86, **SR Tendulkar 5**)

England 302 (KP Pietersen 144, A Flintoff 62, AN Cook 50; H Singh 4–68, Z Khan 3–76) and 64–1

Match drawn

India won the series 1–0

India in New Zealand 2009

1st Test. Hamilton. 18–21 March 2009

New Zealand 279 (DL Vettori 118, JD Ryder 102; I Sharma 4–73, MM Patel 3–60) and 279 (BB McCullum 84, DR Flynn 67, MJ Guptill 48; H Singh 6–63)

India 520 (**SR Tendulkar 160**, G Gambhir 72, R Dravid 66, Z Khan 51*; CS Martin 3–98, IE O'Brien 3–103) and 39–0

India won by 10 wickets

2nd Test. Napier. 26–30 March 2009